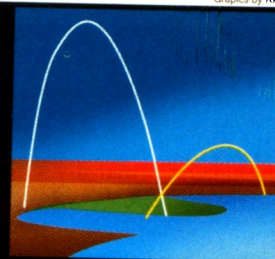
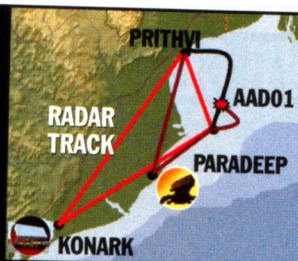


INDIA'S SENTINELS

The country has successfully tested a double layer of interceptors to strike incoming ballistic missiles

1 ENEMY LAUNCH:

The Prithvi ballistic missile poses as the enemy and is launched from Balasore.



GRAPHIC EVIDENCE: The path taken by the interceptor (above left) and the kill moment

EXOATMOSPHERE

ENDOATMOSPHERE

3 FIRST STRIKE: On November 27, 2006 the PAD01 successfully intercepted a Prithvi at the height of 47 km.

2 DETECTION: Two radars stationed at Konark and Paradeep track the missile within 30 seconds of launch.

4 SECOND STRIKE: On December 6, 2007 the AAD01 made a direct hit at a height of 15 km.

WHEELER ISLAND

LONGER RANGE RADARS AND HYPERSONIC INTERCEPTORS STILL NEED TO BE DEVELOPED

rage of interceptors that successfully bring down the remaining two Ghauris. Delhi is saved. India launches a counter nuclear strike that would, as an officer puts it, "make Pakistan not worth living in anymore".

Science fiction? Not really. With a series of major technological breakthroughs recently, scientists of the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) have demonstrated that they are capable of developing an indigenously-built anti-ballistic missile shield that could protect not just Delhi, but other major metros and key installations from enemy nuclear attacks, whether they come in from Pakistan or China. In doing so, India has become the newest member of the rarified club of four nations—the USA, Russia, France and



SELF-RELIANT: Saraswat announces that the test is successful

Israel—having ABM capabilities.

India began revealing its prowess last year itself after keeping the project to develop an ABM system under wraps for close to five years. On a blustery winter morning on November 27, 2006, at the Wheeler Island off the

coast of Orissa, it launched an interceptor missile codenamed PAD01 (Prithvi Air Defence 01) that successfully struck down an incoming Prithvi missile posing as an enemy launch, 47 km above the earth. While the interceptor was indigenously built, the two powerful long and medium-range tracking radars were developed with the help of Israelis and were codenamed Swordfish1 and 2. Together these radars are able to detect an incoming missile 600 km away, identify its trajectory and speed and pass that information on to the control centre. Experts termed the test as the first big step towards developing an effective ABM defence.

The problem was that the Single Shot Probability Kill ratio, as it is known in scientific parlance, is rarely 1:1 for exoatmospheric interceptors (strikes